

For the purpose of this letter, the actual name was replaced with “Candidate”.

Candidate has already been very successful in mathematics competitions in the last years of the primary school. He has been invited to the final rounds of every national competition for his age group, and he has always achieved one of the top 10, or at least one of the top 20 places. I believe that this kind of success gave him the motivation to regularly attend mathematics camps and special weekend sessions for talented students, and moreover, to continue his studies in the specialized mathematics class of Fazekas Mihály High School in Budapest, that has been the most successful in Hungary in this field for decades. Here he became part of a class and a group of highly talented students, which only increased his enthusiasm and his dedication towards mathematics.

Exploring mathematics through discovery and individual problem solving matches Candidate's skills perfectly. He has been a regular problem-solver in KöMaL (Mathematical and Physical Journal for High Schools), and has been successful at various national mathematical competitions: Kalmár László Math. Competition (4th place), Arany Dániel Competition (16th place), Medve Team Competition (1st place), Kenguru Competition (11th place). This list could be continued with similar achievements.

I teach Candidate in the smaller part of his numerous mathematics classes in high school. During these classes, I have been convinced about his fast and accurate conceptualization ability and of the high standards he uses in his proofs. His interests are wide within mathematics, but he has proved himself to be quite able in the topics of combinatorics and elementary number theory. He uses several proof techniques, but he especially likes induction. He gets the notion of the most effective problem-solving methods very quickly, and he can build them into his toolset in the long term. He found excellent proofs in the topic of graphs, and he is far ahead of his age group for showing interest in questions of applied mathematics. He is currently working on a project in this field, where he is investigating the preferences of car customers based on reviews of a Hungarian website under the supervision of Eszter Bokányi, who is a graduate student at Eötvös Loránd University, Budapest. He is presenting his results in English at an international mathematics camp in Poland this September. He is also working with the RECENS Research Group of the Center for Social Sciences at the Hungarian Academy of Sciences in the field of network research, where he is responsible for a programming task. This shows his great interest and capability for computer science as well.

Next to the regular mathematical problem-solving, the weekend mathematical sessions and different mathematical camps, he has been doing sports for years. He has tried out various sports such as football, athletics and rowing. He has represented our school at several sports events with success. His current hobby is Argentinian tango dancing. He is an open-minded and talkative person with a great sense of humour, who is sociable and who takes responsibility in the communities he belongs to. He has many friends in his class and in his broader environment.

Based on his abilities and grades so far, I expect that he is going to graduate with excellent grades of 5 (on a scale of 1 to 5) from all of his two advanced level (Mathematics and English), and his two normal level (Hungarian and History) subjects. He has already graduated from Computer Science with 87% (grade 5) at an advanced level. Studying mathematics in english would mean no difficulty for him as he attended english courses before. His course choice is well-founded, it is the best possibility matching his interests, his thoroughness in mathematics and its toolset, his abstraction ability and his hard-working attitude. I recommend the positive evaluation of his application into a UK undergraduate mathematics course.